

3. Like C, every line of PHP code must end with a semicolon (;), which indicates a line termination.
4. Variables are declared with a \$ symbol; a variable may contain an alphanumeric string, numbers, or an array. Note that in the example below we have declared a variable named “digit”, which is preceded with a \$ symbol.
5. Once again, like C and C++, PHP supports comments enclosed within /* and */. Nesting of comments is impossible, however, as the comment ends as soon as the first */ is encountered. Note that we have used the // operator, which is used for single-line comments. The /* and */ works best for multiple-line comments, and in such a case saves the user from remembering to use a // for every line.

Let’s look at a sample now, our first little program:

Example 1

```
<?php
// this is our first program
// the formatting operators have also been
used here, like <i>, which is the // italics
operator, while <br> simply causes the state-
ments following to go to // the next line. Note
the use of “//” these are the comment inserts
// and statements on the same line as them
are not executed
echo “Question: Are you enjoying this month’s
<i>Fast Track</i> so far?<br><br>”;
$digit=1;
if ($digit==1)
{
    echo “Correct Answer–Yes you
are<br><br>”;
    echo “NOT as much as we enjoyed writ-
ing it I bet!!”;
}
?>
```